For 'Greater Good'

Lakshmi Chandra Kumar, *48*

Mysuru, *Flower seller*

Constituency: Mysuru-Kodagu

Issues that will decide her vote: Work done by party/ candidate

Demands from the govt: Benefits for the poor

Lakshmi's family has been selling the fragrant *sampige* (champak) flowers near the entrance of Mysuru's famous Devaraja Market for three generations. "My grandmother sold flowers at this same spot and so did my parents," she says. The 48-year-old flower-seller reveres the erstwhile royal family of Mysuru, who constructed the market in the 1880s. Hence, she was thrilled to see the titular head of the family, Yaduveer Krishnadatta Chamaraja Wadiyar, whom the Bharatiya Janata Party has fielded from Karnataka's Mysuru-Kodagu seat this election, as he stepped out to campaign in the constituency ahead of the April 26 election.

When she votes, Lakshmi says, she is only thinking about the "greater good" of the people. In the May 2023 Karnataka assembly election, she had voted for the Congress with that thought in mind. She is now a beneficiary of the Siddaramaiah government's Rs 2,000 monthly allowance scheme for eligible women.

For the Lok Sabha election, she was inclined towards the BJP which she says she has heard has done good for people, like building houses. Her final decision, she adds, is made on poll day, though. ■

-Ajay Sukumaran



MADHUSUDHAN SR



PURUSHOTTAM DIWAKAR

AN EQUAL WORLD

Sukanya Ganguly, *31*

Kolkata, *IT consultant*

Constituency: Kolkata Dakshin

Issues that will decide her vote: On-ground development, a democratic environment

Demands from the govt: Spend taxpayers' money wisely, capital investment should uplift life of people

